

i see her in

dyed pink hair & autumn leaves & burning shame
the *tap tap tap* against my skull like sharpener blades;

low *thrum* from brittle ends to roots
she is noisy ; spacious ; encompassing
attention is narrow focus of view and she is overwhelming.

paint a scene like

head pillowed on my lap
leaves filter autumn light
incoherence received softly.

("I tore open your letter and licked the envelope's seal for any lingering trace of you.")

i wake up to find you had never existed;
scrubbed clean of rosters and imaginations
instant noodles bubbling and potato wafting into the air.

my friends dont giggle when the barista calls your name &
i evict the corpse sleeping next to me &
i make room for the next girl.

i mourn the loss of orange fizz
but heal slitted wounds
and laugh.